

**FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE**

# **Vulcan County Residents Seek Judicial Review of AI Data Centre Rezoning Decision**

**Vulcan County, Alberta – Tuesday, August 4<sup>th</sup>, 2026** — Residents have filed an application with the Alberta Court of King's Bench seeking a judicial review of Vulcan County Council's decision to redesignate approximately 595 acres of farm land to industrial use making way for one of the largest AI Data Centre developments contemplated in the province.

The proposed development, a 2.4 GW AI Data Centre, would be located adjacent to the Travers Reservoir - home to Little Bow Provincial Recreation Area, the Southern Alberta Bible Camp (SABC), and the Little Bow Resort—a lakeside community that can welcome over 1,000 residents and visitors every day. The surrounding area has also been recognized as an Environmentally Significant Area (ESA) since the 1980s and provides habitat for several species at risk.

The Little Bow AI Data Centre Committee was formed by residents of the community to examine the potential impacts of this development. Committee member David Anderson says, “This case is about protecting the integrity of our public decision-making process, and ensuring decisions about significant industrial developments occur through a lawful, transparent, and procedurally fair process. Municipalities need to follow their own bylaws, respect environmental protections that have been in place for decades and make decisions based on complete information through a process that is fair to everyone - not just the applicant.”

“The proposed AI Data Centre is fundamentally incompatible with this location,” adds committee member Sylvia Farrant. “This is an Environmentally Significant Area, a critical irrigation and recreational reservoir, and home to one of Alberta’s most respected childrens’ summer camps. It is outrageous that anyone would even consider building a data centre complex, or any other industrial development in this unique area. You couldn’t pick a more inappropriate spot in the province if you tried. Once this location is opened to industrial development there will be no going back.”

Residents have also raised serious public safety concerns, including the potential for fire, and the fact that the only access and evacuation route passes directly into and beside the proposed industrial site. Other concerns with this industrial development include noise, lighting, air, and water pollution.

The Residents are asking the Court to quash the County's decision, declare Bylaw 2026-007 invalid, and require that any future consideration of the proposal occur through a lawful, transparent, and procedurally fair process.

"This judicial review is not about opposing economic development," David Anderson said. "Our community has not opposed previous developments in the region. We have generally accepted those developments without intervention, recognizing the importance of responsible economic

growth. However, we believe this proposal is fundamentally different. Its location adjacent to environmentally sensitive lands, recreational areas, and the Southern Alberta Bible Camp makes it an inappropriate site for a major industrial development.”

The application has been filed with the Alberta Court of King's Bench. The allegations have not yet been determined by the Court, and the matter will proceed through the judicial process.

The judicial review application alleges, among other things, that Vulcan County:

- Approved an application that was materially incomplete and lacked essential planning information required by its own Land Use Bylaw;
- Relied upon planning analyses and information disclosed only after the public hearing had concluded;
- Failed to provide adequate notice to residents directly affected by the proposal;
- Failed to follow its own Land Use Bylaw and Municipal Development Plan;
- Failed to properly consider planning information relating to Environmentally Significant Areas and species at risk; and
- Conducted a public hearing process that did not satisfy the procedural fairness requirements contemplated by Alberta's Municipal Government Act.

## **Media Contact**

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Please scroll down for pictures.



July 2026 overhead view of the Travers Reservoir. Note the proximity to the reservoir / Environmentally Significant Areas as well as the cumulative impact of the solar and wind farm developments. Source: Ryan Wandler



An AI visualization of the proposed Data Center's unsightly & offensive impact on the reservoir.  
Photo looking over the Southern Alberta Bible Camp. Source: David Anderson & ChatGPT



Community sign at the entrance to the Southern Alberta Bible Camp and the Little Bow Resort.  
Source: Alan Duguid, July, 2026.





Line up of vehicles for pick-up / drop off at the Southern Alberta Bible Camp. Source: Alan Duguid, July 2026.



Bank Swallows – a Federally threatened species at the Travers Reservoir. Picture taken July, 2026 on north shoreline of the Travers Reservoir. Source: Tara Girvitz



Long-billed Curlew – species of special concern at the Travers Reservoir. Picture taken south of the proposed AI Data Centre. Source: David Anderson